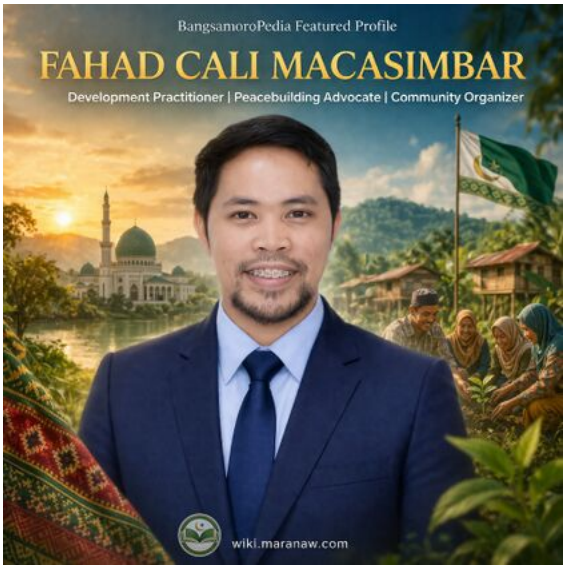
Fahad Cali Macasimbar

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Fahad Cali Macasimbar	
Born	Marawi City, Lanao del Sur
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Education	Bachelor of Public Administration (Mindanao State University)
Profession	Development Practitioner, Peacebuilding Advocate, Community Organizer
Current Position	Project Coordinator, UNYPAD-RANAO
Field	Community Development, Peacebuilding, Governance
Years Active	2017–present (7+ years)

Lead

Fahad Cali Macasimbar is a Filipino development practitioner, youth leader, and peacebuilding advocate from Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, in the Bangsamoro region of Mindanao. With over seven years of grassroots engagement, Macasimbar has emerged as a committed voice for inclusive, participatory development in conflict-affected communities. His work bridges local realities with broader institutional frameworks, focusing on water sanitation and hygiene (WASH), food security, livelihood development, and democratic governance. Currently serving as Project Coordinator at UNYPAD-Relief Assistance Network and Organization, Inc. (UNYPAD-RANAO), he continues to champion community resilience and lasting peace in the Bangsamoro region.

Macasimbar's significance lies not in titles alone, but in his deliberate commitment to empowering marginalized communities. His career reflects a philosophy of public service rooted in trust-building, stakeholder collaboration, and the principle that sustainable development emerges when local voices lead the conversation. As both a practitioner and organizational leader, he exemplifies how technical expertise and grassroots connection can advance peace and governance simultaneously.

Early Life and Background

Fahad Cali Macasimbar was born and raised in Marawi City, the capital of Lanao del Sur province in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM). Growing up in this historic city, Macasimbar witnessed firsthand the complexities of conflict-recovery and community resilience. Marawi City's strategic location and cultural significance in the Muslim-Mindanao region exposed him to diverse development challenges, from post-conflict reconstruction to livelihood gaps and governance gaps affecting vulnerable populations.

His upbringing in a historically significant Muslim community shaped his understanding of peacebuilding not as an abstract concept, but as a lived necessity. This formative context became the foundation for his later commitment to inclusive, participatory development that respects local culture and agency.

Education

Macasimbar earned his **Bachelor of Public Administration** from Mindanao State University (MSU) Main Campus, located in Marawi City.<ref name="educ1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Professional Biography. UNYPAD-RANAO Documentation, 2024.</ref> His academic training in public administration provided him with formal grounding in governance structures, institutional management, and policy frameworks, critical competencies for navigating development work in complex regional contexts.

Beyond his undergraduate degree, Macasimbar obtained his **Licensed Professional Teacher (LPT)** credential in 2025, signaling his deliberate investment in education and capacity-building as a development strategy.<ref name="lpt1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Professional Records. UNYPAD-RANAO, 2025.</ref> This additional qualification reflects his conviction that knowledge transfer and human development form the backbone of sustainable community change.

Throughout his career, he has participated in numerous specialized trainings covering conflict transformation, disability inclusion, legal literacy, culture of peace, social protection, project management, and leadership communication. These continuous learning engagements have deepened his ability to respond to multifaceted development challenges in diverse, politically sensitive contexts.

Professional Career

Early Work as Community Organizer

Macasimbar began his development career as a **Community Organizer** with UNYPAD-Relief Assistance Network and Organization, Inc. (UNYPAD-RANAO), a civil society organization focused on relief, recovery, and sustainable development in the Bangsamoro region.<ref name="career1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Professional History. UNYPAD-RANAO Organizational Records, 2017.</ref> In this foundational role, he developed extensive experience in grassroots mobilization, stakeholder engagement, and field-level program facilitation. His work involved direct engagement with barangay officials, community leaders, and vulnerable populations to understand local needs, build trust, and mobilize collective action around shared development goals.

This phase of his career was marked by a strong field-based orientation. Rather than relying solely on institutional frameworks, Macasimbar prioritized face-to-face engagement, listening processes, and participatory methodologies. His coordination skills and authentic community connection became hallmarks of his approach, contributing to improved development outcomes and deepened community ownership of programs.

Current Role as Project Coordinator

Since advancing to the position of **Project Coordinator** at UNYPAD-RANAO, Macasimbar has assumed broader responsibility for program design, implementation, monitoring, and reporting across multiple thematic areas.<ref name="career2">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Position Description and Organizational Role. UNYPAD-RANAO, 2024.</ref> His current portfolio encompasses:

- **Peacebuilding and conflict transformation**: Designing and facilitating programs that promote dialogue, address underlying causes of conflict, and strengthen social cohesion in post-conflict communities.
- **Water sanitation and hygiene (WASH)**: Overseeing water access, sanitation infrastructure, and hygiene promotion initiatives that address fundamental health and dignity needs.
- **Food security and livelihood development**: Managing interventions that strengthen agricultural productivity, household income diversification, and economic resilience among vulnerable populations.
- **Governance and civic participation**: Supporting institutional strengthening, legal literacy, and citizen engagement in democratic processes and local governance.

As Project Coordinator, Macasimbar bridges multiple stakeholders: government agencies, donor organizations, civil society partners, and community members. He ensures alignment between project activities and donor requirements, institutional policies, and community priorities, a balancing act that demands both technical rigor and political sensitivity.

Institutional Contributions and Organizational Leadership

Beyond his project management responsibilities, Macasimbar serves as **Provincial Secretary** of the UNYPAD Lanao del Sur Chapter. In this leadership role, he supports administrative coordination, member communication, documentation, and partner relations at the provincial level.<ref name="institutional1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Organizational Leadership Record. UNYPAD Lanao del Sur Chapter, 2024.</ref> This position reflects his demonstrated organizational capability and his broader commitment to institutional effectiveness and democratic participation within civil society structures.

His work at the provincial level involves:

- Supporting coordination among UNYPAD members across Lanao del Sur
- Facilitating communication between local chapters and national leadership
- Documentation of organizational activities and institutional learning
- Strengthening partnerships with local government units (LGUs) and barangay officials
- Advocating for member interests and supporting collective action on development priorities

Areas of Thematic Focus

Peacebuilding and Conflict Transformation

Macasimbar's peacebuilding work is grounded in the recognition that Bangsamoro communities have experienced prolonged conflict and require deliberate, culturally sensitive approaches to peace consolidation. Rather than viewing peace as the mere absence of violence, his programs emphasize positive peace: the building of trust, strengthening of institutions, and creation of dialogue spaces where former adversaries can envision shared futures.

His training in conflict transformation has equipped him to facilitate dialogues that move beyond blame toward problem-solving. He understands that sustainable peace in the Bangsamoro region requires addressing both formal institutional dimensions (governance reforms, security sector reform) and relational dimensions (inter-community

reconciliation, narrative change).

Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH)

WASH interventions in the Bangsamoro region are inseparable from governance and dignity. Macasimbar's WASH work ensures that water and sanitation become not just technical infrastructure projects, but expressions of government responsiveness and community agency. His approach integrates health education, institutional coordination with LGUs, and community participation in planning and maintenance.

Food Security and Livelihood

In a region marked by poverty, conflict-induced displacement, and agricultural vulnerability, Macasimbar's livelihood work focuses on building household and community resilience. His programs promote diversified income sources, strengthen agricultural knowledge, and create linkages between small producers and market opportunities. This work reflects an understanding that food security emerges when communities control the means of their own productive life.

Governance and Institutional Strengthening

As someone trained in public administration, Macasimbar views governance strengthening as integral to development. His work supports local government units in improving service delivery, transparency, and citizen participation. He recognizes that weak governance perpetuates poverty and conflict, while responsive, inclusive institutions create foundations for sustainable development.

Continuous Learning and Professional Development

A defining characteristic of Macasimbar's career is his commitment to ongoing professional development. Beyond his formal degrees, he has completed specialized trainings in:

- Conflict transformation and peace education
- Disability inclusion and social protection
- Legal literacy and citizen rights
- Culture of peace and community dialogue facilitation
- Project management and monitoring and evaluation (M&E)
- Leadership communication and organizational development

This investment in learning reflects his belief that development professionals must continuously deepen their understanding of complex realities and emerging best practices. It also signals his humility, his recognition that technical credentials alone are insufficient for navigating the real-world messiness of development work in conflict-affected regions.

Legacy and Professional Impact

Over seven years of dedicated service, Fahad Cali Macasimbar has contributed to multiple dimensions of development and peacebuilding in the Bangsamoro region. His work has touched vulnerable communities, strengthened civil society institutions, and helped bridge local communities with broader development initiatives. His impact manifests not in dramatic headlines, but in sustained community trust, improved service delivery, reduced conflict tensions, and strengthened local capacity.

His legacy is that of a bridge-builder: someone who understands how to translate development principles into culturally appropriate, locally owned programs. He demonstrates that peacebuilding and development are not separate domains, but interconnected efforts that succeed only when rooted in genuine community participation and local leadership.

As the Bangsamoro region continues navigating post-conflict recovery and institutional consolidation, practitioners like Macasimbar remain essential. His work embodies the principle that sustainable peace and development emerge from inside communities, from individuals who choose to stay, build relationships, and invest their lives in collective transformation.

Challenges and Context

Macasimbar's work occurs within significant structural constraints. The Bangsamoro region carries legacies of prolonged conflict, limited state capacity, development gaps, and ongoing political transition. Development practitioners in this context operate with limited resources, complex stakeholder dynamics, and competing priorities between relief, recovery, and transformation.

Despite these constraints, Macasimbar's career represents a commitment to working within local realities rather than imposing external solutions. His approach reflects awareness that sustainable development requires patience, cultural humility, and genuine partnership with communities affected by conflict and poverty.

See Also

- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Marawi City
- Lanao del Sur
- Peacebuilding in Mindanao
- Community-based development
- Water sanitation and hygiene in the Philippines
- Mindanao State University

References

<ref name="educ1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Professional Biography. UNYPAD-RANAO Documentation, 2024.</ref> <ref name="lpt1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Professional Records. UNYPAD-RANAO, 2025.</ref> <ref name="career1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Professional History. UNYPAD-RANAO Organizational Records, 2017.</ref> <ref name="career2">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Position Description and Organizational Role. UNYPAD-RANAO, 2024.</ref> <ref name="institutional1">Fahad Cali Macasimbar. Organizational Leadership Record. UNYPAD Lanao del Sur Chapter, 2024.</ref>

Further Reading

- UNYPAD-Relief Assistance Network and Organization, Inc. Organization Documentation and Program Reports
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao. Official Documentation on Development Priorities
- Peace and Development Organizations. Resources on Community-Based Peacebuilding in Mindanao

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